

Chapter - 3

Communication Barriers

A communication barrier is an obstacle that prevents the receiver from receiving and understanding the message that has been sent by the sender.

Types of Communication Barriers

Physical Barriers

The physical barrier due to the environment and natural factors like noises, different time zones and distances.

Noise and other distractions as they prevent the message from being heard correctly.

Technological problems with equipment used for communication.

Physical disabilities such as hearing problems.

2) Linguistic Barriers

⇒ linguistic barrier occur due to accent, language inability, speech disorders, symbols having multiple and often completely different meanings.

A lack of proficiency in the language affects the interpretation of the message as well.

These issues are also known as semantic issues.

- Use of inappropriate words
- Using difficult and complicated to understand vocabulary
- Incorrect or lengthy sentence formation
- Use of unclear and ambiguous sentences

3) Interpersonal Barriers

⇒ Interpersonal barrier occur due to some inherent traits or the frame of mind of communication. Factors responsible for this barrier include intense emotions, poor listening skills.

Cultural differences due to varying social interaction in different cultures

Sometimes, the receiver may be too excited or tired, or the topic of conversation may not be interesting for the receiver leading to lack of attention to what the sender is saying

Bias against a particular person may lead to false assumptions and miss communication

4) Organisational Barriers:-

⇒ Organisations have their own hierarchical structure that follows procedures, rules and regulations, performance metrics, policies, and communication

Improper channels of communication hinder the flow of communication between different levels of employees.

Negative attitude in workplace

5) Cultural Barriers

Cultural barriers arise because people have different cultural norms and are unable to understand each other's customs.

People make assumptions about others based on their cultural backgrounds which can lead to misinterpretation or bias in communication.

- Various dialects spoken by different cultural groups can affect communication.

Measures to Overcome the Barriers of Communication

1. Keep it simple: Message should be simple and appropriate to serve the purpose of communication.
2. Use correct language: By using appropriate language, the sender can ensure that the receiver

correctly interprets the message.

Use appropriate body language:
The sender should use correct gestures, facial expressions and body posture while talking.

4. Be Sensitive and empathetic: The sender must make it sure that the receiver is in the right frame of mind.

5. Develop Trust:

Mutual trust between the sender and the receiver helps in reducing perception errors.

6. Do not Assume

Assumptions should not be held against a person who is communicating. It is necessary to be open minded while talking.

7. Be unbiased and fair

Do not hold prejudices or be judgemental about people when communicating.

Respect others Culture

Sensitivity and understanding should be developed towards other cultures especially while communicating in a different environment.

